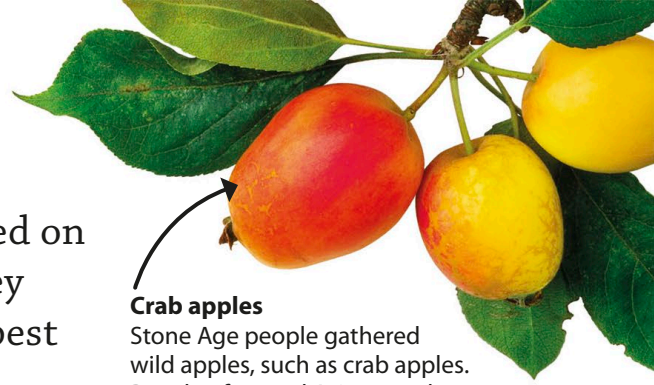


Forest foods

Before farming, Stone Age people relied on the forest for food and medicines. They were highly skilled at identifying the best plants and when and how to use them. If it was edible and tasted good, Stone Age people probably ate it!



Crab apples

Stone Age people gathered wild apples, such as crab apples. People of central Asia were the first to grow apples as crops.

Plums

Full of natural sugar, many varieties of wild plum were gathered by Stone Age people.



Fruit

Wild fruit was the easiest source of sugar for early people. Children especially may well have enjoyed eating the sweet, ripe fruit. When people brought fruit back to camp, they would have scattered fruit seeds unintentionally, and so encouraged fruit to grow near their camps.



Hawthorn

The berries stay on the trees late into winter and the tender leaves are eaten in the spring.



Elderflower

The berries need cooking before eating, and were usually made into drinks.



Blackberries

Blackberries grew wild and their brambles made good cordage (rope).

Sloe berries

These berries become very sweet after a frost. Otzi the Iceman had them in his stomach.



Poisonous plants

Stone Age people learned from experience to avoid poisonous plants. Some plants are not just poisonous to eat but may even be poisonous to touch. Remember to stay away from poisonous plants!



Holly berries

Colorful holly berries may be beautiful, but eating only a few will make both people and animals very sick.